Daffy Duck Is Back on the Big Screen in a Brand-New Looney Tunes Short

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Daffy Duck is heading back to movie theaters. A brand-new Looney Tunes short called "Daffy Season" plays before **screenings** of "The Cat in the Hat," opening Friday from Warner Bros. Pictures. It is the first **theatrically** released Looney Tunes short since "Daffy's Rhapsody" played before "Journey 2: The Mysterious Island" in 2012.

The seven-minute short centers on Daffy Duck, voiced by Eric Bauza. He turns his beak up at his fellow Tunes as they mindlessly obsess over the game of soccer. Jeff Bergman voices Bugs Bunny, Gabriel Iglesias voices Speedy Gonzales, and Jeannie Tirado voices Lola Bunny. Todd Wilderman and Hamish Grieve are the co-directors.

A representative for the studio confirmed that the short is Bauza's final Looney Tunes movie. Bauza is also credited with additional voices for "The Cat in the Hat." Over the past 15 years, Bauza became the **defining** voice of modern Looney Tunes, lending his voice to Bugs Bunny, Daffy Duck, Elmer Fudd, Foghorn Leghorn, Tweety, and Porky Pig. His other Looney Tunes credits include the series "Looney Tunes Cartoons" and the films "The Day the Earth Blew Up: A Looney Tunes Movie" and "Space Jam: A New Legacy." He also starred in "Coyote vs. Acme," a film once deemed **unreleasable** that later grossed $101 million worldwide.

Bauza died at his home in Los Angeles on October 25. In a **tribute**, Warner Bros. Pictures Animation producer Susan Rogers credited him with playing a huge role in reviving Looney Tunes. "There wasn't a single short he couldn't quote or couldn't reference," she said. "I don't think you replace Eric Bauza. The hole he leaves is huge. There are many talented people out there, and the franchise will move on. But there's only one Eric Bauza." Organizers have launched a GoFundMe campaign to support his son, Ryker Bauza, and Ryker's mother, Jessica Borutski.

Word Treasure

theatrically -- In a movie theater, shown on the big screen.
screenings -- Showings of a movie in a theater.
defining -- The one that sets the standard for how something sounds.
tribute -- Words or actions that honor and remember someone.
unreleasable -- Thought to be a film that could never be shown to the public.

Background you need

Looney Tunes is a classic cartoon series from Warner Bros. with famous characters like Bugs Bunny and Daffy Duck, who have entertained audiences for generations.

Short cartoons used to play in theaters before the main movie, and a new short can bring old characters back to the big screen.

Voice actors give cartoon characters their sound and personality, and one actor often voices several different characters.

When a well-loved performer dies, studios and fans often pay tribute to their work and help support their family.

Break it down

LEAD: Daffy Duck returns to movie theaters in a new Looney Tunes short, 'Daffy Season,' playing before 'The Cat in the Hat.'

KEY EVENT: The seven-minute short is the first theatrically released Looney Tunes short since 'Daffy's Rhapsody' in 2012.

+- WHO: Daffy Duck, voiced by Eric Bauza; Bugs Bunny voiced by Jeff Bergman; Speedy Gonzales by Gabriel Iglesias; Lola Bunny by Jeannie Tirado

+- DIRECTORS: Todd Wilderman and Hamish Grieve

+- STORY: Daffy turns his beak up at his fellow Tunes as they obsess over soccer.

+- SIGNIFICANCE: The studio confirmed it is Bauza's final Looney Tunes movie, after 15 years as the defining voice of modern Looney Tunes.

EVIDENCE: Bauza also voiced Bugs Bunny, Elmer Fudd, Foghorn Leghorn, Tweety, and Porky Pig, and starred in 'Coyote vs. Acme,' which grossed $101 million worldwide.

OPEN QUESTION: How will the franchise move on after losing the voice producer Susan Rogers says cannot be replaced?

Why it matters

The short marks both a comeback for theater cartoons and a farewell to the voice behind a generation of Looney Tunes, showing how one performer can shape characters loved around the world.

Test what you remember

1. What is 'Daffy Season'?

- (A) A song from 'The Cat in the Hat'
- (B) A new full-length Daffy Duck movie
- (C) A TV series about soccer
- (D) A brand-new seven-minute Looney Tunes short

2. Before which movie does 'Daffy Season' play?

- (A) Journey 2: The Mysterious Island
- (B) Space Jam: A New Legacy
- (C) Coyote vs. Acme
- (D) The Cat in the Hat

3. When was the last theatrically released Looney Tunes short before this one?

- (A) In 2020
- (B) In 2012
- (C) In 2015
- (D) In 2005

4. Who voices Daffy Duck in the short?

- (A) Todd Wilderman
- (B) Jeff Bergman
- (C) Eric Bauza
- (D) Gabriel Iglesias

5. What did the studio confirm about this short for Bauza?

- (A) He wrote the music for it
- (B) He directed it himself
- (C) It is his final Looney Tunes movie
- (D) It is his first Looney Tunes movie

6. What has been set up to support Bauza's son and his mother?

- (A) A soccer tournament
- (B) A fan club for Daffy Duck
- (C) A GoFundMe campaign
- (D) A new Looney Tunes movie

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: D 3: B 4: C 5: C 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Susan Rogers, Warner Bros. Pictures Animation producer: Says Bauza played a huge role in reviving Looney Tunes, that no one can replace him, and that the hole he leaves is huge.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):